MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS)
REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024
First Semester
Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCPSY100 - COMMUNICATE WITH CONFIDENCE
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Part A

Fill in the Blanks.
Answer all questions.
Each question carries 1 mark

1. Cultural Difference/ Culture (related barriers/ other relevant answers) [K] [4]
2. Confidence [K] [2]
3. Formulation [K] [1]
4. The user [U] [3]
5. Video [U] [2]
6. Language, Cultural, Background (any 1 barrier) [K] [4]
7. Communication Apprehension [U] [1]
8. Space [K] [3]
9. Eye-contact [K] [6]
10. Audio – Visual aids [K] [5]

Part B

Multiple Choice Questions.
Answer all questions.
Each question carries 1 Marks

11. b) To improve skills [U] [2]
12. d) Go to the very first slide of the presentation [U] [3]
13. c) Tailor your message to their interests [K] [2]
14. c) Lack of subject matter expertise [U] [4]
15. c) Social space [K] [1]
16. b) Interrupting the speaker [U] [4]
17. - (as there is a not coming – the students can be given the privilege) [U] [6]
18. b) Icons and Pictures for transition [U] [5]
19. b) Rephrase and clarify the question [A] [4]
20. d) Both statements are true [An] [2]

Part C

Short Answer Questions.
Answer any eight out of thirteen.
Each question carries 2 mark

21. Write on the use of embedded objects in PowerPoint with the help of an example [A] [4]

Use an example to quote the use of embedded objects such as documents – (Slides, Graphics, Use of Transitions and Animations, and Some Special Usage and Features)

22. List any two sources from which lack of articulation can arise [K] [2]

Lack of familiarity with the language, Lack of appropriate reinforcing stimuli like body language, eye contact and voice modulation, Lack of familiarity with the media of communication, Creeping in of nervousness while communicating (any 2)

23. Identify the primary factors that contribute distortion in presentation [K] [4]

Nervousness, lack of preparedness, ineffective use of visual aids, body language, language barriers, time management.

24. Define nonverbal communication [K] [1]

Nonverbal communication is the transmission of meaning from one person to another through means or symbols other than words.

25. Distinguish personal space from social space [U] [1]

Personal space is the are immediately surrounding an individual, used for interaction with close friends and family. Social space is for more formal interaction (workplace, social gatherings)

26. Assess the impact of stage fright on a speaker's credibility. [E] [4]

Speaker to appear unsure, nervous gestures, lack of eye contact, shaky voice (vague answering)

27. List three common types of visual aids used in presentations. [K] [5]

Slides (PowerPoint, Keynote), Diagrams (flowcharts, charts), Graphs (bar charts, line graphs, pie charts) Images (photos, illustrations), Videos, Props, Models

28. Discuss the importance of articulation and pronunciation in effective communication [U] [1]

Clear articulation and correct pronunciation ensure that the message is easily understood, reducing misunderstandings. This is especially critical in professional settings to maintain credibility

29. Analyze the impact of language and cultural barriers on the feedback loop in the communication process. [An] [4]

The feedback loop is supposed to minimize distortion. But in geographically distributed teams (using media like e-mails, phones and chats), this avenue of feedback loop is not always used effectively. Language and cultural barriers can prevent the receiver from fully understanding the message, leading to ineffective feedback.

30. Define organizational barriers. [K] [4]

In a very hierarchical and bureaucratic organization, information may have to flow through several channels. Hence, distortion through the various layers is possible. Also, not all the relevant information may be available to a speaker, because of hierarchy.

31. Why feedback is important in the communication cycle? [U] [1]

Confirms understanding of the message - Allows for assessment of communication effectiveness - Fosters continuous improvement in interactions - Ensures alignment between sender and receiver.

32. Reflect on your experiences in public speaking. How these experiences shaped your confidence and ability to deliver effective presentations? [E] [3]

Identify areas for improvement and work on them. Practice regularly to build confidence and familiarity with the material. Seek feedback from others and learn from your mistakes. Visualize success and maintain a positive mindset. Focus on connecting with your audience and delivering your message effectively.

33. Identify methods to minimize distortion at formulation phase of communication. [K] [4]

Practice effective use body language, spent extra time and effort to get familiar with environment.

Part D

Essay type Questions.
Answer any 2 questions.
Each question carries 7 marks

34. Critically evaluate the impact of technology on professional communication. Consider both positive and negative aspects. [E] [3]

Technology has revolutionized professional communication. Positive aspects: Increased efficiency, global reach, accessibility. Negative aspects: Challenges in maintaining authenticity, potential for misunderstandings, information overload. Discuss specific examples of how technology has affected communication in various professional contexts. Analyze the ethical implications of technology-mediated communication. Make this concise to add to answer reference.

35. Discuss the role of nonverbal communication in building and maintaining relationship. [U] [1]

General Principles - Elements of nonverbal communication- Building trust, expressing affection or distance, regulating interaction.

36. **Analyze the various stages of communication process where distortion can occur. Discuss strategies to minimize distortion in communication**. [An] [1]

1. A sender has to think through what he wants to communicate
2. the inability or ineffectiveness on the part of the speaker to formulate and articulate his thought process effectively - Lack of familiarity with the language, Lack of appropriate reinforcing stimuli like body language, eye contact and voice modulation, Lack of familiarity with the media of communication, creeping in of nervousness while communicating
3. Distortion can be introduced by the media of communication.
4. Distortion can be caused by the receiver's inability to understand the message as it was intended.
5. If a recipient does not understand a message as intended, there is recourse to a feedback loop
6. Inability to act in the intended way

37. Explain the role of eye contact and posture in active listening in educational and counselling settings. [An] [2]

Steps in Active Listening – 3rd step - Tune in to the speaker - Using a posture that favors understanding and conveys confidence to the speaker and Providing eye contact to the speaker (connect with educational and counseling setting).